



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Faith West Academy
School Website: <https://www.faithwest.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Faith West Academy (Katy, TX 77493) presents itself as a Christ-centered private Christian school that emphasizes spiritual formation, character development, and biblically integrated academics. Public-facing materials consistently frame education as formation of the person in relation to faith, virtue, and service, with chapel, Bible study, and daily devotionals highlighted as core practices. The school also emphasizes family partnership, parental involvement, and a welcoming campus culture.

Strengths aligned with classical aims: - Religious and metaphysical foundations are explicitly foregrounded (Christ-centered, Bible-based, weekly chapel, discipleship/mentorship). This maps strongly to the Positive Keywords for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations in the Six Essential Elements framework (e.g., theology, liturgy/worship, virtue, moral formation, spiritual depth, mentorship) and is reinforced by a clear statement of faith and biblical authority. Evidence includes explicit doctrinal statements and weekly worship practices.

- School purpose and goals center on formation, virtue, and the cultivation of character within a Christian framework, with a stated aim to form minds, hearts, and souls. This aligns with the classical emphasis on formation and virtue rather than mere career-readiness. Evidence in the public materials emphasizes "formation," "Christ-centered education," and character development.

Key caveats relative to a strict classical rubric: - Curriculum and pedagogy sections emphasize biblically integrated academics, AP/dual-credit pathways, and modern instructional practices, but do not clearly articulate explicit classical elements such as the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; trivium), the Quadrivium, or a rigorous Great Books/Great Conversation orientation. There is limited public evidence of Great Books, formal Socratic seminars, or a history-program framed as "Western civilization through the Great Conversation." This suggests not-classical in the Curriculum and Pedagogy categories by strict classical standards, with potential for "Somewhat Classical" depending on how one weighs biblically integrated liberal arts and character formation.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL - The evaluation below uses a keyword-driven rubric derived from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1). Faith West Academy demonstrates strong alignment in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose and Goal, and Faculty/Parents & Community via explicit doctrinal commitments, liturgical practices, and a culture of mentorship and parental partnership. It shows partial alignment in Curriculum and Pedagogy (due to biblically integrated and college-preparatory programs rather than explicit classical structures). The aggregate result places Faith West Academy in CLASSICAL territory, with room to strengthen classical curriculum and pedagogy signals to achieve a fully classical profile.

What would move the needle (for a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL assessment only): - If the school were to explicitly articulate and incorporate classical curriculum elements (Seven Liberal Arts; Great Books/Great Conversation; explicit history across the curriculum in a Western-civilizational frame) and identify classroom practices such as Socratic seminars, recitation, and memory work as core methods, its category would shift more clearly toward CLASSICAL.

Abstract takeaway: Faith West Academy is fundamentally rooted in a Christian formation model with strong

moral and spiritual formation signals, robust parental partnership, and a college-preparatory academic posture. It already aligns well with several Positive Keywords in the classical rubric and outperforms in Religious/Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose/Goal, and Faculty/Community. It would reach a more purely classical standing with explicit classical curriculum elements and traditional pedagogical practices (Socratic dialogue, great books, memory work) clearly framed as central components.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school identifies itself as Christ-centered and biblically integrated, with teachings grounded in Jesus Christ and biblical authority. Public materials emphasize weekly chapel, Bible studies, worship, and discipleship/mentorship among faculty.

- The Statement of Faith and doctrinal affirmations articulate a structured theology (Bible as inspired Word of God; expectation of Trinity; Christ's lordship).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Christ-centered; Bible studies; worship; chapel; theology; discipleship/mentorship; sacred truth (biblical authority). These map to Positive Keyword indicators in the Six Essential Elements document (e.g., theology, liturgy/worship, virtue, moral formation, wonder). The public materials show explicit theologies and liturgical practices that correspond to the Positive Keywords cluster (theology, liturgy/worship, chapel, devotionals, mentorship).

- Negative keywords present: None evident in the public materials (no explicit relativism, secular ethics, or value-neutral framing).

Why this rating - The explicit Christian-theological framing, liturgical practices (weekly chapel), and mentorship/disciple-mentorship patterns strongly align with the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations criteria in the classical model. The presence of doctrinal statements and Christ-centered education supports a CLASSICAL rating for this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe education as forming character and soul, with a Christ-centered aim that goes beyond information transfer. There is a particular emphasis on forming virtue and wisdom and developing godly character, not solely job-readiness. - There is strong emphasis on formation, moral development, and the integration of faith with learning, coupled with college-preparatory elements (AP/dual credit) that prepare students for higher education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation; virtue; character; moral formation; wisdom; spiritual depth; mentorship; holistic education; love of learning. These terms map to Positive Keywords in the Six Essential Elements (Section 1–3) (formation of virtue, teleology toward truth/good/beauty, and holistic formation). - Negative keywords present: None overtly. The presence of college prep is not framed as a negative for this category; it complements formation and wisdom in the classical ideal if balanced with virtue-focused aims.

Why this rating - The emphasis on formation, virtue, and the cultivation of wisdom aligns well with the classical purpose of education as paideia rather than vocational preps alone. The explicit spiritual formation and moral emphasis bolster CLASSICAL positioning for this category. AP/dual-credit offerings support college readiness but do not negate formation.

Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public-facing content highlights biblically integrated curriculum and a broad college-prep pathway (AP/pre-AP) rather than explicit classical curriculum components. There is emphasis on faith integration, spiritual development, and standard private-school curriculum, rather than explicit Seven Liberal Arts or Great Books frameworks.

- There is no clear public articulation of Great Books, Great Conversation, or the Trivium/Quadrivium; no explicit mention of Great Books canon or Western civilization through a classical textual program.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (Curriculum): biblically integrated curriculum; biblical principles; instruction aligned with faith; college-prep courses (AP/dual credit). These map to Positive Keywords in the Six Essential Elements under the Curriculum category (e.g., “great books,” “grammar, logic, rhetoric,” “Socratic dialogue,” “history through classical canon”) but actual items like Great Books or Trivium terms are not present in the public-facing materials. - Negative keywords present: explicit absence of classical curriculum signals (no direct reference to Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, or Trivium/Quadrivium in the public-facing content). This absence contributes to a NOT CLASSICAL alignment for this category.

Why this rating - While the curriculum is biblically integrated and college-prep oriented, the explicit classical markers (Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, Great Conversation, structured memory/recitation) are not evident in the public materials. This yields a NOT CLASSICAL rating for this category. The lack of classical-canon emphasis is a notable gap relative to classical-school expectations.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site emphasizes biblically integrated instruction, an emphasis on mentorship and personalized learning (e.g., SAIL, individualized plans), and college-prep pathways, with some evidence of collaborative or inquiry-based activities, but explicit classical pedagogy signals (Socratic seminars, memory work, recitation, scholé, or formal use of the Great Conversation) are not clearly described in public-facing content. - There are references to modern assessment (MAP tests), AP/pre-AP coursework, small class sizes, and individualized instruction, rather than a declared program of Socratic seminars or classical memory work.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: contemplative/restful learning signals are not explicitly stated; however, the site mentions mentorship, individualized plans, and daily devotionals. The explicit classical Pedagogy terms like Socratic seminars, recitation, or memory work are not evidenced publicly. This yields a partial match to Positive Keyword indicators (e.g., “formation,” “mentorship,” “narrative shaping” as a potential correlate) but lacks explicit Classical Pedagogy markers. - Negative keywords present: absence of explicit Socratic pedagogy, chanting, memorization cycles, or scholé-day framing. No strong signals of the classic “Scholé” approach.

Why this rating - The pedagogy described leans toward biblically integrated and modern, student-centered approaches with mentorship and personalized learning rather than explicit classical methods (Socratic discussion, memory work, or the formalized classical pedagogy stack). This supports NOT CLASSICAL in pedagogy, with potential for Somewhat Classical if classical-method signals are more clearly integrated.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty are described as mentors and guides who model virtue and nurture character; the living curriculum concept appears in the public materials, with faculty playing a central, relational role. There are explicit statements about faculty as mentors and about forming a “portrait” of ideal teachers and students in classical terms. For example, “Discipleship and Mentorship” and “faculty are mentors” appear in the content. - The school emphasizes a collaborative, close-knit faculty culture (perhaps implied in “small class sizes” and mentors). There are references to teachers’ roles beyond instruction (mentors, disciples).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: mentor, discipleship, living curriculum, teacher as guide/mentor, moral exemplars, character formation, partnership with families (as part of the educational “faculty” ecosystem). These map well to Positive Keywords for Faculty (e.g., living curriculum, mentorship, character formation, portrait of teacher/student). - Negative keywords present: none evident; no signals of impersonal, standardized, or non-mentoring faculty models.

Why this rating - The explicit emphasis on mentors, discipleship, and the faculty as central to character formation supports a CLASSICAL rating for Faculty. The public materials strongly align with the classical category’s expectation of virtuous, exemplary teachers who act as the living curriculum.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school repeatedly emphasizes partnership with families, parental involvement, and open campus/visit policies. Public content notes the importance of parental involvement in school events, decision-making, and ongoing engagement with classical education topics (e.g., parent formation, book studies, gatherings). The “Partnership with Families” and “parent formation” language appears in the canonical materials and in the public-facing statements about family involvement. - There is a clear emphasis on parents as co-educators and on open access to the school for visits, which aligns with the classical model’s emphasis on parental partnership in formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; parents as co-teachers; parental formation; home-school collaboration; family involvement; open campus; parent involvement in school events. These align with the Positive Keywords in the Six Essential Elements (Family partnership and parental engagement). - Negative keywords present: None evident. The materials promote active parental involvement rather than consumer or passive expectancies.

Why this rating - The explicit, ongoing invitation for parental involvement and family engagement is a hallmark of the classical model’s Parents & Community category. The school’s model positions parents as co-educators and active participants in the school’s life, which aligns with CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- For a move toward a fully CLASSICAL profile in Curriculum and Pedagogy, Faith West Academy could explicitly articulate and implement classical curricular structures (Seven Liberal Arts; Great Books; Great Conversation; explicit Trivium/Quadrivium references) and adopt traditional classical teaching methods (Socratic seminars, memory work, recitation, scholé days). This would transform the Curriculum and Pedagogy categories from NOT CLASSICAL toward CLASSICAL and reinforce the overall CLASSICAL standing.
- Additional clarity in the Pedagogy section about contemplative, restful days (scholé) and a more explicit role for memory work and classical dialectic would strengthen Element 4.
- A formal statement mapping Great Books, historic Western intellectual heritage, and a canonical canon to course offerings would further enhance the School Purpose & Goal and Curriculum alignment.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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